Letters of application and CVs

Objective: Write a formal letter of application and a short CV, respecting their layout, sections and polite formal language.

In two lines: A letter of application presents you and asks for a job or a place in a training programme. A CV lists your personal details, education, skills and experience in a clear, organised way.

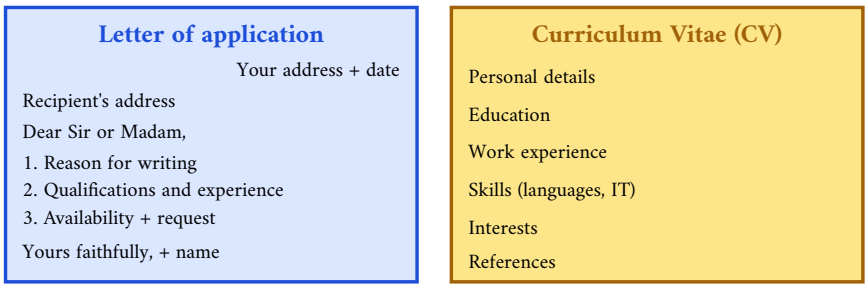


Figure 1: The layout of a letter of application (left) and the sections of a CV (right).

🔵 Rules and concepts

1. **Layout:** your address and the date at the top right; the recipient's address on the left, below.
2. **Salutation and ending:** *Dear Sir or Madam* → *Yours faithfully*; *Dear Mr Brown* → *Yours sincerely*.
3. **Opening paragraph:** say why you are writing and where you saw the advertisement: *I am writing to apply for the post of…*
4. **Body:** describe your qualifications, experience and qualities: *I have experience in…*, *I am fluent in…*
5. **Closing paragraph:** availability and polite request: *I look forward to hearing from you.*
6. **Formal style:** no contractions (*I am*, not *I'm*), no slang, short clear paragraphs.
7. **CV:** headings, short notes instead of full sentences, and the most recent information first.

🟢 Examples

1. Informal: *I want the job you put in the paper.* **Formal answer:** I am writing to apply for the position advertised in yesterday's newspaper.
2. Informal: *Write back soon!* **Formal answer:** I look forward to hearing from you.
3. CV line for skills: **Answer:** Languages: Arabic (native), French and English (good); IT: word processing.

🟠 Common BAC mistakes

- Ending *Dear Sir or Madam* with *Yours sincerely*.
- Using contractions and informal phrases such as *Hi* or *Bye*.
- Forgetting to mention the job and where it was advertised.
- Writing the CV as a long paragraph instead of headings.

🟡 Quick review

- Addresses + date + salutation + 3 paragraphs + ending.
- Sir or Madam → faithfully; name → sincerely.
- Formal language, no contractions.
- CV = clear headings and short notes.

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